

Henry Hetherington

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Henry Hetherington was born in Soho in 1792, the son of a tailor. Trained as a printer, he later set up his own press in Holborn and published radical newspapers, including the Political Economist, Universal Philanthropist and the Poor Man's Guardian.

A leading figure in the "War of the Unstamped", Hetherington fought against the newspaper tax, believing everyone should have access to affordable news. His Poor Man's Guardian supported universal suffrage, a free press and working-class causes, including the Tolpuddle Martyrs. He was imprisoned three times for publishing unstamped newspapers.

His campaigns helped inspire the Chartist movement and the fight for political reform. Hetherington remained active until his death from cholera in 1849.

